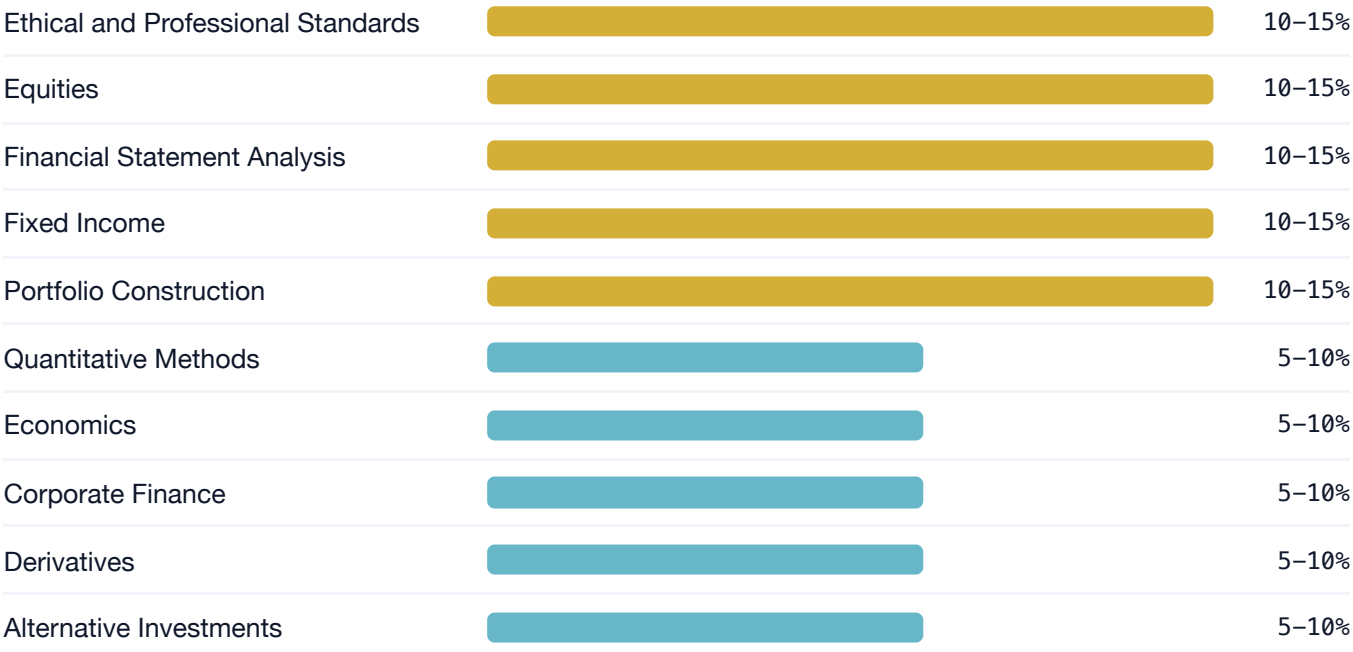
FINANCE IN PRACTICE · FREE GUIDE

CFA® Level II *Exam Map*

Where the marks are, how item sets work, and a 12-week route to exam day.

22	88	2 × 132	300+
item sets (a case plus four questions)	multiple-choice questions	minutes, two sessions	study hours reported by passing candidates

Where the marks are



High priority: the heaviest topics. Weights: CFA Institute 2027 topic outline.

> **The five gold topics are 50–75% of the exam.** Level II is about applying models to a case. Equity and fixed income valuation, FSA and ethics carry the result.

Exam windows: Level II runs in May, August and November. Check dates and fees at cfainstitute.org.

12-WEEK ROUTE

A plan that follows how topics build on each other

About 25 hours a week. Studying 15 hours a week? Stretch the same order over 20 weeks.

Wk 1	**Quantitative Methods + Economics**	Regression output and currency parity: read them, don't derive them.
Wk 2–3	**Financial Statement Analysis**	Intercorporate investments, multinationals, earnings quality.
Wk 4	**Corporate Finance**	Capital structure, dividends, ESG and restructuring.
Wk 5–6	**Equities**	DCF, residual income and multiples. Heaviest valuation block.
Wk 7–8	**Fixed Income**	Term structure, arbitrage-free trees, credit analysis.
Wk 9	**Derivatives + Alternative Investments**	Pricing forwards, swaps and options; real estate and private capital.
Wk 10–11	**Portfolio Construction + Ethics**	Ethics last, so it is fresh on exam day.
Wk 12	**Mock exams + review**	Full item-set mocks under time. Fix the error pattern.

Exam-day rules worth knowing

- **About 3 minutes per question.** Each item set should take about 12 minutes.
- **Read the questions before the case.** Then read the vignette knowing what to look for.
- **Cases include data you don't need.** Spotting the right number is half the question.
- **No penalty for wrong answers.** Never leave a question blank.

Want this plan built around your exam date?

Book a free 30-minute diagnostic session. We find your weak topics and map your route to exam day. At your home in Abu Dhabi or live online.

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